

Assignment 7

PROCEDURE TO CREATE AN ANIMATED CURSOR USING STARTDRAG("SS", TRUE); MOUSE.HIDE();

Aim

To create an animated cursor in Flash by using a movie clip and ActionScript functions like `startDrag()` and `Mouse.hide()`.

Procedure

1. Open Flash by going to **Start** → **Macromedia** → **Flash Document**.
2. Draw or insert an object (e.g., a butterfly).
3. Select the object using the **Free Transform Tool**.
4. Right-click the object and choose **Convert to Symbol**.
 - Select **Movie Clip**
 - Name it **mm**
 - Click **OK**
5. In the **Properties Panel**, set the **Instance Name** also as **mm**.
6. With the object selected, go to: **Modify** → **Timeline** → **Distribute to Layers**
7. Rename **Layer 1** to **Action**.
8. Select the first keyframe in the Action layer.
9. Open the Actions panel: **Window** → **Actions**
10. Enter the following code:

```
Mouse.hide();
this.mm.onEnterFrame = function() {
    startDrag(this, true);
};
```

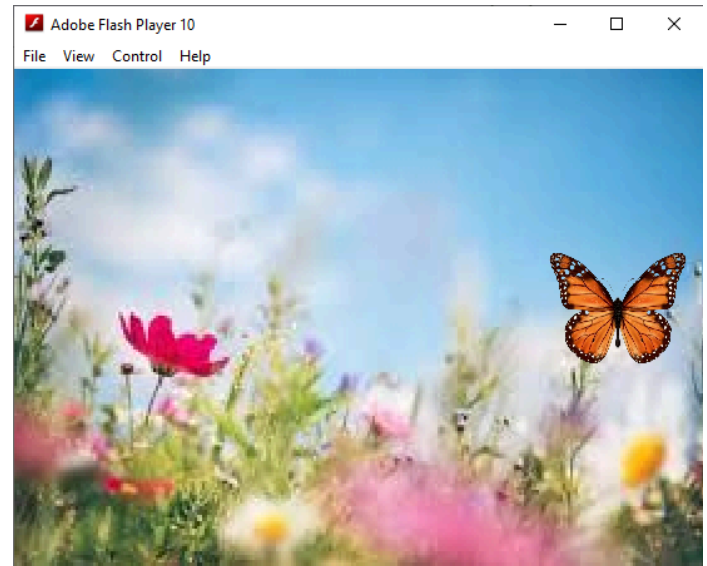
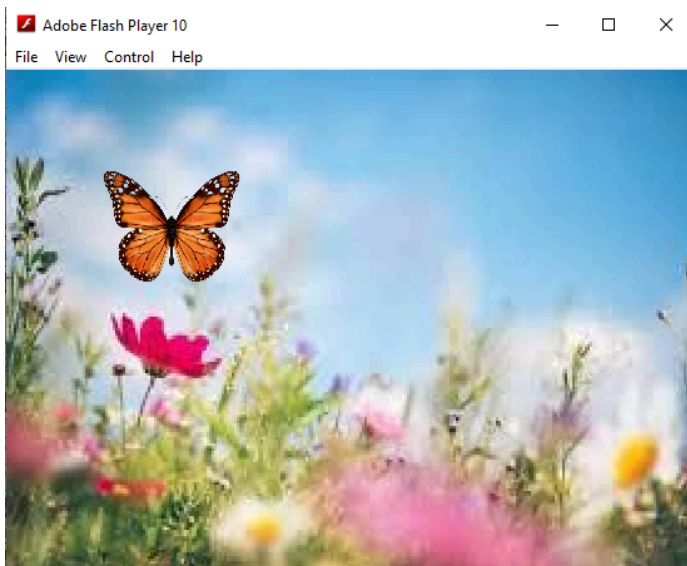
11. Run the animation using:
Control → **Test Movie**

Explanation of Code

- `Mouse.hide();`
Hides the default system cursor.
 - `this.mm.onEnterFrame = function()`
Runs the function continuously for every frame.
 - `startDrag(this, true);`
Makes the movie clip follow the mouse cursor.
The `true` parameter keeps the object centered with the cursor.
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Output

- The default mouse cursor becomes invisible.
- The selected object (e.g., butterfly) acts as a custom animated cursor.
- The object smoothly follows the movement of the mouse.



Result

The animated cursor was successfully created using a movie clip and ActionScript. The object replaced the default cursor and followed mouse movement accurately.